The calculator gave you a number. Prices are how you reach it, and part-timers price from what they see other people charge, not from what the business has to clear. Every tier below starts at its floor: the price that holds your 50% margin at 34 weddings a year after overhead, cash costs and sales tax. The floor is the minimum, not the price. Price to your market above it, and keep the ramp rising.

Weddings a year to price for

Defaults to the bookings your quit number needs at today's average. Overhead per wedding is $247 at this volume.

34 a year

TIERS

Three **Four**

Tier name	Coverage hours	Extra cash cost of this tier's inclusions	Your price (0 = use the floor)	Share of bookings, %
The Ceremony	7	0	0	30

Floor **$3,316** Price **$3,350** Net margin **50.5%** clears Per hour **$479**

Tier name	Coverage hours	Extra cash cost of this tier's inclusions	Your price (0 = use the floor)	Share of bookings, %
The Story	10	420	0	45

Floor **$4,240** Price **$4,800** Net margin **55.8%** clears Per hour **$480** Step **x1.43**

Tier name	Coverage hours	Extra cash cost of this tier's inclusions	Your price (0 = use the floor)
The Feature	12	700	0

Share of bookings, %: 20

Floor **$4,856** Price **$5,800** Net margin **58.1%** clears Per hour **$483** Step **x1.21**

Tier name	Coverage hours	Extra cash cost of this tier's inclusions	Your price (0 = use the floor)
The Heirloom	12	1800	0

Share of bookings, %: 5

Floor **$7,276** Price **$7,300** Net margin **50.2%** clears Per hour **$608** Step **x1.26**

The ramp rises at every step. Each tier earns at least as much per hour as the one below it, so nothing cannibalises the tier above.

Do not sell base hours plus add-on hours on every tier. That rebuilds the hourly trap. Take hour counts off anything a couple sees, put a finish time and a continuation rate in the contract, and set that rate at or above your top tier's price per hour ($608 here).

BACKWARDS FROM THE NUMBER

$4,690	$79,466	$100,800	$4,919
Average sale at this mix (30/45/20/5)	Profit at 34 weddings, before your tax	Your quit number	Average sale that reaches the number at 34 weddings

This ladder does not reach your number. At 34 weddings and this mix it is $21,334 a year short. Lift prices toward an average of $4,919, move the mix up the ladder, or add bookings. Lifting the average is the lever that does not cost Saturdays.

The floor prices only protect the margin. Reaching the quit number is a separate test, and it is the one that decides the resignation date. The share of bookings is your guess until you have twenty consults on these prices.

ADD-ONS, EACH WITH ITS OWN MARGIN

ADD-ON	CASH COST	RETAIL	MARGIN
Second photographer, 8 hours	560	1750	64.8% ok
Engagement session	0	1600	100.0% ok
Fine art album	1100	2600	53.5% ok
Extra hour of coverage	0	850	100.0% ok

Cash cost only. Your own hours on an engagement session are not a cost, they are capacity, so its margin reads high and its real price is a Saturday morning. Never discount or gift the thin ones.

WHAT PART-TIMERS LEAVE OUT

Overhead a year	$8,412
Overhead per wedding at 34	$247
Gear sinking fund a year	$0
Your wage, as the quit number	$100,800
Your own retirement contribution	$10,800
Sales tax on every sale	10%
Cash out per wedding	$1,260

Every one of these sits inside the floor prices above. Income tax then comes out of what is left, which is why the quit number is a before-tax figure.

CAPACITY CHECK

About 13.0 of your hours per wedding (shooting plus culling at 0.35 an hour, editing outsourced) times 34 weddings over 46 working weeks is **9.6 hours a week** on weddings alone, before enquiries, consults and admin.

Print this page for the Module 1 worksheet. Rates as at 8 November 2026. Not tax advice.